ANGELA M. TORRES, LCSW

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SENIOR EXECUTIVE SERVICE CANDIDATE • HEALTHCARE QUALITY & OVERSIGHT • BEHAVIORAL HEALTH • ACCOUNTABILITY

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Federal healthcare oversight executive and licensed clinical social worker with 20+ years at the Department of Veterans Affairs, rising from frontline behavioral health care to national leadership of clinical quality reviews. Currently serves as Executive Director (Acting) of Clinical Quality Review in VHA's Office of Quality and Patient Safety, directing national reviews of care at 170 VA medical centers. Executive oversight spans ~95 clinical reviewers and analysts, a $22M budget, and findings that shape care for 9M+ enrolled Veterans; senior VA leaders rely on her to turn review findings into fixes that last.

TECHNICAL & EXECUTIVE QUALIFICATIONS ALIGNMENT

Healthcare Leadership	Leads national clinical quality reviews for 170 VA medical centers and 9M+ Veterans; directed 140+ investigations. Achieved 88% on-time corrective action closure.
Commitment to the Rule of Law	Applied VA directives, Title 38, and whistleblower protections at 52 facilities; reviews withstood OIG and congressional scrutiny. Achieved 94% concurrence.
Driving Efficiency	Consolidated 3 regional teams into one national office; $22M budget; risk-based targeting. Cut recommendation closure time from 410 to 180 days.
Merit and Competence	Built a reviewer competency model and certification track; member of SES and GS-15 selection panels; placed 12 internal promotions into lead roles.
Leading People	Leads ~95 reviewers and analysts nationwide; previously led 110 social workers and a 300-person service line; mentors new supervisors.
Achieving Results	Closed suicide-risk screening gaps at 40+ sites; findings drove 3 new VHA directives; cut mental health wait times from 21 to 9 days.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Executive Director (Acting), Clinical Quality Review Oct 2025 – Present

Office of Quality & Patient Safety, VHA, U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs | Washington, DC

Pay Plan/Series/Grade: SES (Acting) / GS-0601-15 | Hours/Week: 40+ | Supervisor: AUSH for Quality (May Contact)

Leads VHA's national program for clinical quality reviews, adverse-event analysis, and corrective action tracking across all VA medical centers.

- **Restructured three regional review teams into a single national Clinical Quality Review office**, standardizing review protocols, reporting templates, and escalation paths across 18 VISNs.
- **Led VHA's predictive risk analytics for quality oversight,** combining patient safety reports, suicide-risk indicators, and staffing data to target reviews at the 25 highest-risk facilities.
- **Redesigned the national corrective-action tracking process,** cutting average time to close recommendations from 410 to 180 days and raising on-time closure from 52% to 88% within one year; oversaw ~$6M in analytics and review-support contracts.
- **Lead integrator for VHA's behavioral health quality initiative,** coordinating the Office of Mental Health and Suicide Prevention, VISNs, and facility leaders to close gaps in suicide-risk screening and safety planning at 40+ sites.
- **Established and chairs the National Review Board,** giving senior leaders a single forum to prioritize high-risk findings and assign accountable owners.
- **Briefed the Under Secretary for Health and congressional staff 20+ times** on systemic quality findings, leading to 3 new VHA directives on behavioral health safety.

Director, Western Region Investigations Feb 2023 – Oct 2025
Office of the Medical Inspector, Veterans Health Administration | Denver, CO
Pay Plan/Series/Grade: GS-0601-15 | Hours/Week: 40 | Supervisor: Medical Inspector (May Contact)
Directed clinical investigations of care quality, patient safety, and whistleblower disclosures at 52 VA facilities across 6 western VISNs.

- **Led 140+ clinical investigations** with interdisciplinary teams of physicians, nurses, and social workers, issuing 600+ recommendations with a 94% concurrence rate.
- **Built the region's first behavioral health investigation track,** later adopted nationally, focused on suicide prevention, residential treatment, and homeless programs.

Senior Health Systems Specialist Jun 2020 – Feb 2023
Office of the Medical Inspector, Veterans Health Administration | Denver, CO
Pay Plan/Series/Grade: GS-0601-14 | Hours/Week: 40 | Supervisor: Regional Director (May Contact)
Led on-site and virtual reviews of mental health, community care, and patient safety programs at VA medical centers.

- **Served as team lead on 45+ reviews,** writing findings and recommendations published to senior VA leadership and Congress, and mentoring 8 new reviewers.

EARLIER FEDERAL & CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Chief, Social Work Service | VA Salt Lake City Health Care System (GS-14) | Mar 2017–Jun 2020: Led 110 social workers across a medical center and 9 clinics; launched a caregiver support program serving 1,400 families.

Acting Associate Chief, Behavioral Health | VA Salt Lake City HCS (Detail) | Jan 2019–May 2019: Directed a 300-person service line; reduced mental health wait times from 21 to 9 days.

Supervisory Social Worker, Behavioral Health | VA Eastern Colorado HCS (GS-13) | Aug 2013–Mar 2017: Supervised 24 clinicians in residential and outpatient programs; raised program completion rates 18%.

Suicide Prevention Coordinator | VA Eastern Colorado HCS (GS-12) | Jul 2010–Aug 2013: Built high-risk tracking for 900+ Veterans; trained 2,000+ staff in safety planning and lethal-means counseling.

Veterans Justice Outreach Specialist | VA Eastern Colorado HCS (GS-11) | May 2008–Jul 2010: Linked 350+ justice-involved Veterans to treatment; helped launch 2 Veterans treatment courts.

Clinical Social Worker, Forensic Unit | Colorado Mental Health Institute | Jun 2005–May 2008: Provided assessment and treatment planning for court-ordered patients on a 60-bed forensic unit.

Medical Social Worker | Denver Health Medical Center | 2003–2005: Coordinated discharge planning and crisis intervention for emergency and inpatient psychiatry patients.

EDUCATION

Master of Social Work — Clinical Concentration 2003
Arizona State University | Phoenix, AZ

Advanced Certificate, Forensic Social Work 2009
University of Denver | Denver, CO

Executive Leadership Program 2023
Federal Executive Institute, U.S. Office of Personnel Management | Charlottesville, VA

B.A., Psychology 2001
University of Colorado | Boulder, CO

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

VHA Under Secretary for Health Award for Quality Improvement • Office of the Medical Inspector Leadership Award (×2) • VA Secretary's Hands & Heart Award • Regional Social Worker of the Year • VISN 19 Suicide Prevention Excellence Award

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Licensed Clinical Social Worker (LCSW – CO, UT) • Certified Professional in Healthcare Quality (CPHQ) • Lean Six Sigma Green Belt • Root Cause Analysis Facilitator